

Chapter 1 – Introduction to Taxpayer Identification Number (TIN)

1.1 What is a Taxpayer Identification Number (TIN)?

A **Taxpayer Identification Number (TIN)** is a unique identification number issued by the **Inland Revenue Department (IRD) of Sri Lanka** to identify taxpayers for tax administration purposes. Every registered taxpayer is assigned a unique TIN, which remains the primary reference number for interacting with the IRD.

The TIN enables the Inland Revenue Department to maintain taxpayer records, administer taxes efficiently, process tax returns, monitor tax compliance, and provide access to IRD electronic services (e-Services). Both individuals and organizations can obtain a TIN based on their legal status and tax obligations.

A TIN is required to access various IRD services, including:

- Tax registration
 - e-Services login
 - Filing tax returns
 - Making tax payments
 - Requesting refunds
 - Updating taxpayer information
 - Applying for a Personal Identification Number (PIN)
 - Receiving tax-related notices and certificates
-

1.2 Purpose of a TIN

The primary purpose of a Taxpayer Identification Number is to uniquely identify every taxpayer registered with the Inland Revenue Department. The TIN serves as the official reference number for all tax-related transactions and communications.

The objectives of introducing the TIN include:

- Identifying taxpayers accurately.
- Maintaining a centralized taxpayer database.
- Improving tax administration and compliance.
- Facilitating electronic tax services.
- Simplifying communication between taxpayers and the IRD.
- Supporting tax return filing and payment processing.
- Reducing duplicate taxpayer records.
- Enabling integration with other government services where tax identification is required.

The TIN also supports the government's efforts to improve transparency, strengthen revenue administration, and modernize Sri Lanka's digital tax system.

1.3 Legal Background

The Inland Revenue Department (IRD) is responsible for registering taxpayers and issuing Taxpayer Identification Numbers under Sri Lanka's tax administration framework.

Recent government policy changes expanded TIN registration requirements. According to the documents, income tax registration became mandatory for individuals aged 18 years and above from **1 April 2024**. Registration does not automatically create an income tax liability; rather, it establishes a taxpayer record within the IRD system.

The TIN functions as the official identification number used by the IRD for:

- Income tax administration
 - Taxpayer registration
 - Taxpayer profile management
 - Electronic service authentication
 - Tax compliance monitoring
 - Communication regarding tax obligations
-

1.4 Why Sri Lanka Introduced Mandatory TIN Registration

Sri Lanka introduced mandatory TIN registration to improve tax administration, enhance public service delivery, and establish a comprehensive taxpayer database.

The main reasons include:

- Creating a single, reliable taxpayer identification system.
- Supporting digital transformation through IRD e-Services.
- Improving tax compliance and reducing tax evasion.
- Strengthening government revenue collection.
- Simplifying access to financial and government services that require taxpayer identification.
- Enhancing the accuracy of taxpayer information maintained by the IRD.

Mandatory registration also allows the IRD to coordinate information with other institutions and

improve the administration of tax-related services.

1.5 Benefits of Having a TIN

A Taxpayer Identification Number provides access to numerous tax and government services, even for individuals who are not required to pay income tax.

Tax Administration Benefits

- Register as a taxpayer with the IRD.
- Access IRD e-Services.
- Apply for a Personal Identification Number (PIN).
- File income tax returns electronically.
- Make tax payments.
- Request tax refunds.
- Update taxpayer details.
- Obtain tax clearance certificates.
- Receive official communications from the IRD.

Financial and Government Services

A TIN may be required for:

- Opening certain bank accounts.
- Registering ownership of land.
- Registering or transferring motor vehicles.
- Renewing vehicle revenue licences.
- Obtaining building plan approvals.
- Import and export activities.
- Business registration and regulatory compliance.
- Submitting bank interest self-declarations where applicable.

As the TIN becomes increasingly integrated into government and financial systems, it serves as an important identifier for many public and commercial transactions.

1.6 Difference Between a TIN and Paying Income Tax

A common misconception is that obtaining a TIN means an individual must pay income tax. This is incorrect.

A TIN is a taxpayer identification number, whereas income tax liability depends on a person’s taxable income and the applicable provisions of Sri Lankan tax law.

Key differences include:

Taxpayer Identification Number (TIN)	Income Tax Liability
Identifies a taxpayer within the IRD system.	Refers to the legal obligation to pay income tax.
Required for taxpayer registration and many IRD services.	Applies only when a person’s taxable income exceeds the applicable tax-free threshold and other legal requirements.
Can be issued even if no tax is payable.	May not arise if the individual’s income is below the applicable threshold.
Used for accessing e-Services, updating taxpayer records, and communicating with the IRD.	Determined by taxable income, reliefs, deductions, and the relevant provisions of the Inland Revenue Act

Therefore, every eligible person may be required to obtain a TIN, but not every TIN holder is required to pay income tax. Registration establishes a taxpayer record, while the obligation to pay tax depends on the individual’s taxable income and applicable tax laws.

Chapter 2 – Eligibility and Who Must Register for a Taxpayer Identification Number (TIN)

2.1 Introduction

The **Taxpayer Identification Number (TIN)** is the official identification number issued by the Inland Revenue Department (IRD) to taxpayers in Sri Lanka. Registration requirements vary depending on the legal status of the applicant, such as an individual, partnership, company, trust, or other entity.

From **1 April 2024**, Sri Lanka introduced mandatory TIN registration for individuals aged 18 years and above. Although registration is compulsory for eligible persons, obtaining a TIN does **not** automatically create an obligation to pay income tax. Income tax liability depends on the applicable provisions of the Inland Revenue Act and the individual's taxable income.

2.2 Who Must Register for a TIN?

The following categories of persons and entities are generally required to obtain a TIN.

2.2.1 Individuals

Individuals who are required to register include:

- Sri Lankan citizens aged 18 years or above.
 - Salaried employees.
 - Self-employed individuals.
 - Sole proprietors.
 - Freelancers.
 - Professionals (such as doctors, lawyers, engineers, accountants, consultants, etc.).
 - Individuals earning rental income.
 - Individuals earning investment income.
 - Persons carrying on any trade, business, profession, or vocation.
 - Individuals required to interact with IRD e-Services.
-

2.2.2 Sole Proprietorships

A sole proprietorship is owned by a single individual. The business owner must register for a TIN using their personal information together with details of the business.

Information generally required includes:

- Business name
 - Business registration number
 - Principal business activity
 - Date of commencement
 - Business address
 - BOI registration status (if applicable)
-

2.2.3 Partnerships

Registered partnerships are required to obtain a TIN.

Registration generally requires:

- Partnership registration certificate
 - Details of all partners
 - National Identity Cards (NICs) or passports of partners
 - Supporting registration documents
-

2.2.4 Companies

All registered companies should obtain a TIN.

This includes:

- Private Limited Companies
- Public Companies
- Unlimited Companies
- Companies Limited by Guarantee
- Foreign Companies
- Offshore Companies

Company registration generally requires information relating to:

- Certificate of Incorporation
- Company registration details
- Directors
- Registered office

- Principal business activity
 - Articles of Association
 - Registrar of Companies (ROC) documents
-

2.2.5 Trusts

Trusts are also eligible for taxpayer registration.

Generally required documents include:

- Trust Deed
 - Identification documents of trustees
 - Supporting registration documents where applicable.
-

2.2.6 Joint Ventures

Joint ventures undertaking business activities in Sri Lanka may register for a TIN.

Supporting documents may include:

- Joint Venture Agreement
 - Copies of partners' TIN certificates
 - Letter of authority (where applicable)
 - Project documentation.
-

2.2.7 Non-Governmental Organizations (NGOs)

Registered NGOs may obtain a TIN where required for tax administration purposes.

Registration generally requires organizational registration documents together with supporting identification and authorization documents.

2.2.8 Government and Semi-Government Institutions

Government organizations and semi-government institutions may register as taxpayers where applicable.

Supporting documents may include:

- Gazette or Act establishing the institution
 - Letter of authorization
 - Registration documents.
-

2.2.9 Foreign Nationals

Foreign nationals conducting business or earning taxable income in Sri Lanka may require a TIN.

Identification is generally established using:

- Valid passport
 - Local address (where applicable)
 - Supporting business or employment documentation.
-

2.3 Who May Need a TIN Even If They Do Not Pay Income Tax?

Having a TIN does not necessarily mean that income tax is payable.

A TIN may still be required for individuals who:

- Are students aged 18 years or above.
 - Are unemployed.
 - Are homemakers.
 - Have no current taxable income.
 - Earn less than the income tax threshold.
 - Receive foreign income.
 - Maintain bank accounts.
 - Own vehicles or property.
 - Need to use IRD electronic services.
-

2.4 Situations Where a TIN Is Commonly Required

A TIN may be requested when carrying out various financial, legal, and administrative activities, including:

Banking

- Opening certain bank accounts.
- Maintaining specific banking relationships.
- Submitting self-declarations relating to withholding tax on interest.

Property

- Registering land ownership.
- Registering deeds.
- Property transactions.

Motor Vehicles

- Vehicle registration.
- Transfer of ownership.
- Renewal of revenue licences.

Business Activities

- Registering businesses.
- Import and export activities.
- Regulatory compliance.

Government Services

- Building approvals.
- Various public administrative procedures.
- Access to IRD online services.

2.5 Persons Who May Not Immediately Have an Income Tax Liability

Registration for a TIN should not be confused with paying income tax.

A registered taxpayer may have **no income tax payable** if, for example:

- Their taxable income is below the applicable personal relief threshold.
- They have no taxable income during the relevant Year of Assessment.

- Their available reliefs and deductions reduce their tax liability to zero.

Even in these situations, the individual may still be required to hold a valid TIN for administrative or legal purposes.

2.6 Automatic Registration

The Inland Revenue Department has introduced mechanisms to improve taxpayer registration.

According to the uploaded guidance, information received from third parties, including banks and certain government agencies, may be used to identify persons who should be registered for a TIN. In some circumstances, individuals may receive a TIN through these processes and may later need to activate their IRD e-Services account or update their taxpayer details.

2.7 Key Points

- A TIN is the official taxpayer identification number issued by the Inland Revenue Department.
- Registration requirements differ for individuals, businesses, companies, partnerships, trusts, and other entities.
- Individuals aged 18 years and above are generally required to register for a TIN.
- Possessing a TIN does not automatically create an obligation to pay income tax.
- A TIN is increasingly required for access to IRD services and many financial and government transactions.
- Tax liability depends on taxable income and the applicable provisions of Sri Lankan tax law, not simply on holding a TIN.

Chapter 3 – Documents Required for TIN Registration

3.1 Introduction

To register for a **Taxpayer Identification Number (TIN)**, applicants must submit a completed registration application together with supporting documents that verify their identity, legal status, and business information (where applicable). The exact documents required depend on the type of taxpayer.

Applicants should ensure that all documents are complete, accurate, and valid before submission. Where original documents are presented in person, photocopies should also be provided. For online applications, clear scanned copies of supporting documents must be uploaded.

3.2 General Requirements

Regardless of the type of applicant, the following requirements generally apply:

- Completed TIN Registration Application Form.
- Valid identification documents.
- Supporting documents relevant to the applicant’s category.
- Proof of address where required.
- Clear copies of supporting documents for online applications.
- Original documents may be required for verification during in-person registration.

3.3 Documents Required for Individuals (Including Sole Proprietors)

Individuals applying for a TIN should submit the following documents:

Required Document	Description
Application Form	Completed TIN registration application.
National Identity Card (NIC)	Required for Sri Lankan citizens.

Passport	Required for foreign nationals.
Business Registration Certificate	Required for sole proprietors operating a registered business.
Proof of Address	Required if the address differs from the NIC. Acceptable documents include a utility bill, bank statement/passbook, or Grama Niladhari certificate. Foreign nationals should provide local address proof.

3.4 Documents Required for Partnerships

A registered partnership should provide:

Required Document	Description
Application Form	Completed application form.
Partnership Registration Certificate	Proof of legal registration.
NIC or Passport of Every Partner	NIC for Sri Lankan partners or passport for foreign partners.

3.5 Documents Required for Registered Companies

Companies must submit supporting documents proving their legal incorporation and ownership.

Required documents include:

Required Document	Description
Application Form	Completed registration form.

Certificate of Incorporation	Company incorporation certificate issued by the Registrar of Companies.
Form 01	Certified by the Registrar of Companies.
Form 05	Certified copy where applicable.
Form 40	Certified copy where applicable.
Form 20	Certified copies relating to directors.
Form 13	Required where applicable.
Form 18	Required where Form 20 is used to recognize directors' signatures.
Articles of Association	Company constitution document.
Directors' Identification	NIC for Sri Lankan directors or passports for foreign directors.
BOI Registration Certificate	Required for Board of Investment registered companies, where applicable.

3.6 Documents Required for Trusts

Trusts should submit:

Required Document	Description
-------------------	-------------

Application Form	Completed application.
Trust Deed	Official trust document.
Trustees' Identification	NIC for Sri Lankan trustees or passports for foreign trustees.

3.7 Documents Required for Joint Ventures

Joint ventures should provide:

Required Document	Description
Application Form	Completed registration form.
Joint Venture Agreement	Agreement between participating parties.
Copies of Partners' TIN Certificates	Where available.
Power of Attorney	Required where applicable.
Project Agreement	Where applicable.
Cabinet Approval	Required for certain government-approved projects.

3.8 Documents Required for Projects, NGOs, and Other Organizations

Depending on the legal status of the organization, the following may be required:

Required Document	Description
Application Form	Completed registration form.
Letter of Request	Issued by the head of the organization.
Registration Certificate	Organization registration

	certificate.
Letter of Appointment	Appointment of the authorized signatory.
Minutes of AGM or Executive Report	Where applicable.
Confirmation from Head Office	Required for branch offices.
Gazette or Act	Required for government or semi-government institutions.

3.9 Proof of Address

If the residential or business address differs from the National Identity Card or official records, proof of address should be provided.

Examples include:

- Utility bill
- Bank statement
- Bank passbook
- Grama Niladhari Certificate
- Local address proof for foreign nationals

According to the guidance, supporting documents should be current and clearly display the applicant's name and address.

3.10 Documents Required for Online Registration

Applicants using the IRD e-Services portal should prepare electronic copies of all supporting documents before beginning the registration process.

Supporting documents should be:

- Clear and readable.
- Complete.
- Uploaded under the correct document type.
- Submitted together with the online registration application before final declaration.

3.11 Declaration and Submission

Before submitting a TIN registration application, applicants are generally required to:

- Review the application summary.
- Confirm that the information provided is true, correct, and complete.
- Enter their name.
- Enter their designation (where applicable).
- Provide a contact number.
- Submit the declaration electronically or in person.

After successful submission, an acknowledgement is generated. Applicants are advised to retain the acknowledgement for future reference.

3.12 Important Notes

- All information provided during registration should be accurate and supported by valid documentation.
- Additional documents may be requested by the Inland Revenue Department where necessary.
- Incomplete applications or missing supporting documents may delay processing.
- For online applications, applicants should ensure all uploaded files are legible and correspond to the selected document type.
- Applicants should retain copies of all submitted documents and the acknowledgement receipt for future reference.

3.13 Key Points

- Required documents vary depending on the taxpayer category.
- Individuals primarily require identification and proof of address.
- Business entities require registration and incorporation documents in addition to identification.
- Supporting documents must be provided during both online and manual registration.
- An application is not considered complete until the declaration has been submitted and an acknowledgement has been issued.

Chapter 4 – Methods of TIN Registration

4.1 Introduction

The Inland Revenue Department (IRD) provides several methods for obtaining a **Taxpayer Identification Number (TIN)**. Applicants may choose the most convenient registration method based on their circumstances. Registration can be completed **online**, **in person**, or **by post**. Each method requires the submission of a completed application together with the necessary supporting documents.

4.2 Available Registration Methods

The Inland Revenue Department currently provides the following registration methods:

Registration Method	Suitable For	Processing Method
Online Registration	Individuals and businesses with internet access	Through the IRD e-Services Portal
In-Person Registration	Applicants who prefer visiting an IRD office	At the Taxpayer Services Unit (TPSU) or an IRD office
Postal Registration	Applicants unable to visit an IRD office or use online services	

4.3 Online Registration

Online registration is the most convenient method for obtaining a TIN. Applicants submit their information electronically through the IRD e-Services Portal without visiting an IRD office.

The general process includes:

1. Visit the Inland Revenue Department e-Services Portal.
2. Select **Taxpayer Registration**.
3. Choose the appropriate registration type (e.g., Individual, Registered Company, Partnership).
4. Complete the online application form.
5. Upload all required supporting documents.
6. Select the purpose of registration.
7. Complete the declaration by providing the required information.
8. Submit the application.
9. Receive an electronic acknowledgement confirming successful submission.
10. Wait for the IRD to process the application and issue the TIN.

Advantages of Online Registration

- Accessible from any location with internet access.
- No need to visit an IRD office.
- Electronic submission of supporting documents.
- Immediate acknowledgement after submission.
- Convenient tracking of application progress through IRD e-Services.

Important Notes

- Applicants should prepare scanned copies of all supporting documents before starting the application.
- Uploaded documents should be clear and complete.
- The declaration section must be completed before submission.
- Keep the acknowledgement number for future reference.

4.4 In-Person Registration

Applicants may register by visiting an Inland Revenue Department office, including the Taxpayer Services Unit (TPSU).

The registration process generally involves:

1. Obtain the TIN registration application form.
2. Complete the application.
3. Present the required original documents together with photocopies where applicable.
4. Submit the application to the IRD officer.

5. The officer verifies the information and supporting documents.
6. If the application is complete, the TIN may be issued immediately or after processing.

Advantages

- Direct assistance from IRD officers.
- Immediate clarification of registration issues.
- Original documents can be verified during submission.
- Suitable for applicants requiring additional guidance.

Office Hours

According to the IRD guidance:

- Monday to Friday
- **8:30 a.m. – 4:00 p.m.**
- Excluding public holidays.

4.5 Registration by Post

Applicants who cannot register online or visit an IRD office may submit their application by post.

The process generally includes:

1. Obtain the registration application form.
2. Complete the application accurately.
3. Attach all required supporting documents.
4. Mail the application to the Inland Revenue Department.
5. The IRD processes the application.
6. The TIN certificate is sent by post after approval.

Applicants should ensure that all required documents are enclosed to avoid delays.

4.6 Comparison of Registration Methods

Feature	Online	In-Person	By Post
Internet required	Yes	No	No

Visit IRD office	No	Yes	No
Upload documents	Yes	No	No
Submit original documents	No	Yes	Certified copies where required
Immediate assistance	No	Yes	No
Acknowledgement	By post or IRD processing		

4.7 Processing Time

Processing time may vary depending on:

- Completeness of the application.
- Accuracy of submitted information.
- Verification of supporting documents.
- Registration method used.
- Volume of applications received by the IRD.

According to the uploaded guidance:

- Online applications may take several working days after successful verification.
- Applications submitted in person may be processed immediately where documentation is complete.
- Postal applications generally require additional time due to document delivery and processing.

4.8 Who Can Submit the Application?

Submission requirements differ according to the type of taxpayer.

Applicant Type	Authorized Person
----------------	-------------------

Individual (Sole Proprietor)	Owner
Partnership	One of the Partners
Company	Director
Authorized Representative	Person holding a valid Letter of Authority

Where an application is submitted by an authorized representative, an official **Letter of Authority** may be required.

4.9 After Registration

After successful registration:

- The IRD reviews the application.
- A Taxpayer Identification Number (TIN) is assigned.
- Applicants receive confirmation of registration.
- The TIN can then be used to access IRD services, request a PIN, log in to e-Services, file tax returns, make tax payments, and update taxpayer information.

4.10 Common Reasons for Registration Delays

Applications may be delayed due to:

- Missing supporting documents.
- Incorrect or incomplete application forms.
- Unclear or unreadable uploaded files.
- Invalid identification documents.
- Inconsistent personal or business information.
- Failure to complete the declaration section.

Applicants should review all information carefully before submission to minimize delays.

4.11 Key Points

- The IRD provides **three methods** of TIN registration: **Online, In-Person, and By Post.**
- Online registration is generally the most convenient option for applicants with internet access.
- In-person registration allows applicants to receive assistance from IRD officers and may offer faster processing when documents are complete.
- Postal registration remains available for applicants who cannot register online or visit an IRD office.
- All registration methods require the submission of accurate information and supporting documents.
- Applicants should retain their acknowledgement after submitting the registration application.

Chapter 5 – Online TIN Registration Process

5.1 Introduction

The Inland Revenue Department (IRD) provides an online registration facility through its **e-Services Portal**, allowing eligible individuals and organizations to apply for a **Taxpayer Identification Number (TIN)** without visiting an IRD office.

The online registration system is designed to simplify the registration process by enabling applicants to submit their personal or business information, upload supporting documents, and receive an acknowledgement electronically. Upon successful verification, the IRD issues a Taxpayer Identification Number (TIN) to the applicant.

5.2 Before You Begin

Before starting the online registration process, applicants should prepare the following:

- National Identity Card (NIC) or Passport.
 - Business Registration Certificate (if applicable).
 - Proof of Address (if required).
 - Email address.
 - Mobile phone number.
 - Scanned copies of all supporting documents.
 - Stable internet connection.
-

5.3 Accessing the IRD e-Services Portal

To begin the registration process:

1. Open a web browser.
2. Visit the Inland Revenue Department (IRD) website.
3. Navigate to **e-Services**.
4. Select **Access to e-Services**.
5. Choose **Taxpayer Registration**.

Applicants must then select the appropriate registration category based on their taxpayer type.

5.4 Selecting the Registration Type

The system provides different registration categories.

Common registration types include:

- Individual Local
- Registered Company
- Partnership
- Joint Venture
- Other eligible entities

Applicants should choose the category that matches their legal status before proceeding with the application.

5.5 Registering as an Individual Taxpayer

Individuals should select "**Individual Local**" as the registration type.

The registration form requires applicants to enter their personal information accurately.

The required information generally includes:

- Full Name
- National Identity Card Number
- Date of Birth
- Gender
- Nationality
- Country of Birth
- Preferred Language
- Preferred Communication Method

All mandatory fields should be completed before moving to the next section.

5.6 Entering Address Information

Applicants must provide their address information.

The system requests:

Permanent Address

This should be the applicant's official permanent residence.

Residential Address

If different from the permanent address, the residential address should also be provided.

Applicants should ensure that the addresses entered match the supporting documents where required.

5.7 Contact Information

Applicants are required to provide valid contact details, including:

- Mobile Number
- Email Address

Providing accurate contact information is important because the IRD uses these details for:

- Registration updates
- Notifications
- Future communication
- PIN-related correspondence
- e-Service activation

Applicants are encouraged to verify that both the mobile number and email address are active before submitting the application.

5.8 Bank Information

The registration form also includes a section for bank information.

Applicants should provide accurate banking details where requested by the system. These details assist the Inland Revenue Department in maintaining complete taxpayer records.

5.9 Registering an Individual Business (If Applicable)

Applicants operating as sole proprietors may register their business during the TIN registration process.

Select **"Add Business"** and provide:

- Business Name
- Business Registration Number
- Principal Business Activity
- Date of Commencement
- Business Address
- BOI Registration Status
- Whether it is the Primary Business

Applicants with multiple businesses may add each business separately before continuing with the registration.

5.10 Registering as a Company

Companies should select **"Registered Company"** during registration.

Company registration generally requires the following information:

- Registered Company Name
- Company Registration Number
- Registered Address
- Contact Details
- Parent Company Information (if applicable)
- BOI Registration Details (if applicable)
- Directors' Information

The applicant must enter complete and accurate company information before proceeding.

5.11 Adding Directors

For company registrations, directors must be added individually.

The system allows applicants to search for directors using:

- TIN
- NIC
- Passport Number

If a director already exists in the IRD database, their information may be retrieved automatically.

Additional directors can be added as required before continuing.

5.12 Uploading Supporting Documents

Applicants must upload all required supporting documents before submitting the application.

The process involves:

1. Selecting the appropriate document type.
2. Choosing the correct supporting document category.
3. Uploading scanned copies.
4. Confirming successful upload.

Documents should be:

- Clear
- Complete
- Legible
- Correctly categorized

Incomplete or unclear documents may delay application processing.

5.13 Purpose of Registration

Applicants are required to specify the purpose of obtaining the TIN.

The selected purpose should accurately reflect the reason for registration before proceeding to the declaration section.

5.14 Declaration

Before submitting the application, applicants must review all information entered.

The declaration requires:

- Name
- Designation (where applicable)
- Contact Number

By submitting the declaration, the applicant confirms that all information provided is true, correct, and complete.

5.15 Submission and Acknowledgement

After successful submission:

- The system displays a confirmation page.
- An acknowledgement number is generated.
- Applicants should print or save the acknowledgement for future reference.

The acknowledgement number may be required when communicating with the Inland Revenue Department regarding the application.

5.16 After Submission

Once the application has been submitted:

1. The Inland Revenue Department reviews the application.
 2. Supporting documents are verified.
 3. Additional information may be requested if necessary.
 4. Upon approval, a Taxpayer Identification Number (TIN) is issued.
 5. Applicants may then proceed to request a **Personal Identification Number (PIN)** to access IRD e-Services.
-

5.17 Common Mistakes to Avoid

Applicants should avoid the following mistakes:

- Providing incorrect NIC or passport details.
- Entering an invalid email address or mobile number.
- Uploading unclear or incomplete documents.
- Selecting the wrong registration type.
- Omitting mandatory fields.
- Failing to complete the declaration.
- Submitting inconsistent personal or business information.

Carefully reviewing the application before submission helps prevent processing delays.

5.18 Key Points

- The IRD e-Services Portal allows taxpayers to register for a TIN online.
- Applicants must choose the correct registration category before completing the application.
- Accurate personal or business information and valid supporting documents are essential.
- An acknowledgement is generated after successful submission and should be retained.
- After the TIN is issued, applicants can request a Personal Identification Number (PIN) to access IRD e-Services.

Chapter 6 – Personal Identification Number (PIN) for IRD e-Services

6.1 Introduction

A **Personal Identification Number (PIN)** is a secure authentication credential issued by the **Inland Revenue Department (IRD)** that enables registered taxpayers to access the **IRD e-Services Portal**. While a **Taxpayer Identification Number (TIN)** identifies a taxpayer, the **PIN** allows the taxpayer to securely log in and use online tax services.

Only taxpayers who have successfully obtained a TIN can apply for a PIN. Without a PIN, taxpayers cannot access most online services provided through the IRD e-Services Portal.

6.2 What is a PIN?

A Personal Identification Number (PIN) is a unique security code issued by the Inland Revenue Department after a taxpayer has successfully registered for a TIN.

The PIN is used to:

- Access the IRD e-Services Portal.
- Authenticate the taxpayer's identity.
- Protect taxpayer information.
- Enable secure online tax transactions.

The PIN is confidential and should only be known by the taxpayer or an authorized representative.

6.3 Why is a PIN Required?

A PIN is required to perform various online tax-related activities through the IRD e-Services Portal.

These include:

- Logging into IRD e-Services.
- Registering for tax types.
- Filing tax returns.
- Viewing taxpayer information.

- Updating taxpayer profile details.
 - Managing tax registrations.
 - Authorizing staff or tax agents.
 - Accessing other electronic tax services.
-

6.4 Eligibility for Obtaining a PIN

Only registered taxpayers are eligible to obtain a PIN.

Applicants must first:

1. Register with the Inland Revenue Department.
2. Obtain a valid Taxpayer Identification Number (TIN).

Once a TIN has been issued, the taxpayer may request a PIN through the IRD e-Services Portal or by visiting an IRD office.

6.5 Methods of Obtaining a PIN

The Inland Revenue Department provides two methods for obtaining a PIN.

Method 1 – Online PIN Request

Applicants may request a PIN through the IRD e-Services Portal.

The process is as follows:

1. Visit the IRD website.
2. Open **e-Services**.
3. Select **Access to e-Services**.
4. Choose **PIN Request**.
5. Enter the required reference number.
6. Provide personal details.
7. Submit the request.

After verification, the IRD processes the application and sends the PIN by post to the taxpayer's registered address.

Method 2 – In-Person PIN Request

Applicants may also visit:

- IRD Head Office
- Any Regional Inland Revenue Office

The applicant should submit:

- National Identity Card (NIC) or Passport.
- Letter of authorization (for company representatives where applicable).
- Supporting identification documents.

The IRD officer generates the PIN and provides it in a sealed PIN Mailer.

6.6 Information Required for Online PIN Request

During an online PIN request, the applicant is generally required to provide:

For Individuals:

- TIN or National Identity Card Number

For Companies:

- Company Registration Number (ROC)

In addition, the applicant must provide:

- Full Name
- Mobile Number
- Email Address

After completing the application, the request is submitted electronically.

6.7 Receiving the PIN

Once the request is approved:

- The IRD generates a PIN.
- A PIN Mailer is prepared.
- The PIN Mailer is sent to the taxpayer's registered postal address.

If the PIN Mailer is not received within approximately two weeks, taxpayers are advised to contact or visit the nearest IRD office.

6.8 First Login After Receiving the PIN

When accessing the IRD e-Services Portal for the first time:

- Enter the TIN.
- Enter the system-generated PIN.
- Complete the login process.

For security reasons, the system requires the taxpayer to **change the system-generated PIN** during the first login.

The taxpayer cannot continue using e-Services until a new PIN has been created.

6.9 Changing the PIN

The Inland Revenue Department requires taxpayers to replace the system-generated PIN with a new personal PIN.

The new PIN must satisfy the system's minimum security requirements.

Once changed:

- The old system-generated PIN becomes invalid.
 - Only the newly created PIN can be used for future logins.
-

6.10 Forgotten or Lost PIN

If a taxpayer forgets the PIN:

- A new PIN request should be submitted online, or
- The taxpayer may visit an IRD office to request a replacement PIN.

Every new PIN request generates a completely new PIN.

Any previously issued PIN becomes invalid immediately after the new PIN is generated.

6.11 PIN Security

Taxpayers should take appropriate measures to protect their PIN.

The IRD recommends:

- Do not share the PIN with other individuals.
- Store the PIN securely.
- Change the PIN periodically.
- Avoid writing the PIN where unauthorized persons may access it.

Maintaining PIN confidentiality helps protect taxpayer information from unauthorized access.

6.12 Account Lockout

For security reasons, the IRD e-Services Portal locks an account after **five consecutive incorrect login attempts**.

When an account is locked:

- The taxpayer cannot access e-Services.
- A new PIN may need to be requested if the PIN cannot be recalled correctly.

This security measure helps protect taxpayer accounts from unauthorized access.

6.13 Common Issues and Solutions

Issue	Possible Solution
PIN Mailer not received	Wait up to two weeks; if still not received, visit the nearest IRD office.
Forgot PIN	Request a new PIN online or at an IRD office.
First login unsuccessful	Ensure the system-generated PIN is entered correctly before changing it.
Account locked	Follow the IRD procedure to obtain a new PIN or seek assistance from the IRD.
Previously used PIN rejected	Only the most recently created PIN is valid.

6.14 Best Practices

Taxpayers are encouraged to:

- Keep their mobile number and email address up to date.
- Ensure their registered postal address is accurate to receive the PIN Mailer.
- Change their PIN periodically.
- Log out after using the IRD e-Services Portal.
- Use a supported web browser when accessing the portal.
- Avoid multiple incorrect login attempts.

6.15 Key Points

- A **PIN** is required to access IRD e-Services.
- Only taxpayers with a valid **TIN** can obtain a PIN.
- PINs can be requested online or by visiting an IRD office.
- The system-generated PIN must be changed during the first login.
- Every new PIN request invalidates all previously issued PINs.

- Accounts are locked after five consecutive incorrect login attempts.
- Taxpayers should keep their PIN confidential and update it periodically.

Chapter 7 – Accessing and Using IRD e-Services

7.1 Introduction

The **Inland Revenue Department (IRD) e-Services Portal** is an online platform that enables registered taxpayers to perform a wide range of tax-related activities electronically. Once a taxpayer has obtained a **Taxpayer Identification Number (TIN)** and a **Personal Identification Number (PIN)**, they can securely access the portal to manage their tax obligations without visiting an IRD office.

The e-Services Portal supports individuals, companies, authorized staff, and registered tax agents, providing secure access based on the user's role and permissions.

7.2 What is the IRD e-Services Portal?

The IRD e-Services Portal is an online system developed by the Inland Revenue Department to provide electronic tax services.

Through the portal, taxpayers can:

- Access their taxpayer profile.
 - Register for tax types.
 - File tax returns.
 - Update registration details.
 - Manage tax information.
 - Authorize staff or tax agents.
 - Submit tax-related requests.
 - Access various IRD electronic services.
-

7.3 Requirements for Accessing e-Services

Before accessing the portal, a taxpayer should have:

- A valid Taxpayer Identification Number (TIN).
- A Personal Identification Number (PIN).
- Internet access.
- A supported web browser.
- A registered email address and mobile number.

Companies and tax agents may also require Staff Identification Numbers (SSID) for authorized employees.

7.4 Types of Users

The IRD e-Services Portal supports different categories of users.

Individual Taxpayer

Individual taxpayers access the portal to manage their own tax matters.

They can:

- View taxpayer information.
 - Update personal details.
 - Register for tax types.
 - File tax returns.
 - Access other personal tax services.
-

Corporate Taxpayer

Companies access the portal to manage business tax obligations.

Authorized company users can:

- Register tax types.
 - Update company information.
 - Submit tax returns.
 - Authorize staff.
 - Manage company tax records.
-

Staff Users (SSID)

Companies may authorize employees to use the portal through a **Staff Identification Number (SSID)**.

Authorized staff can perform tax-related work on behalf of the company according to the permissions granted by the company.

Staff access is limited to the tax types and roles assigned by the company.

Tax Agents

Registered tax agents may access the portal to provide tax services for their clients.

Tax agents can only act on behalf of taxpayers who have formally authorized them through the IRD system.

Tax agents are generally assigned the **Preparer** role and cannot submit returns unless permitted by the applicable authorization framework.

7.5 Login Process for Individual Taxpayers

To log in as an individual taxpayer:

1. Visit the IRD website.
2. Open **e-Services**.
3. Select **Access to e-Services**.
4. Choose **Individual Taxpayer**.
5. Enter the TIN.
6. Enter the PIN.
7. Enter the verification code displayed on the screen.
8. Click **Login**.

Upon successful authentication, the taxpayer is redirected to the e-Services dashboard.

7.6 Login Process for Corporate Taxpayers

Companies should:

1. Access the IRD e-Services Portal.
2. Select **Corporate Taxpayer**.

3. Enter the company's TIN.
4. Enter the employee's TIN or SSID.
5. Enter the PIN.
6. Complete the security verification.
7. Click **Login**.

Only authorized employees may successfully access company records.

7.7 Login Process for Tax Agents

Registered tax agents should:

1. Open the IRD e-Services Portal.
2. Select **Tax Agent**.
3. Enter the Tax Agent Company's TIN.
4. Enter the user's TIN or SSID.
5. Enter the PIN.
6. Complete the security verification.
7. Click **Login**.

The company represented by the tax agent must have previously authorized the tax agent through the IRD authorization process.

7.8 Main Services Available Through e-Services

After logging in, taxpayers can access numerous online services.

These include:

Registration Services

- TIN Registration
- Tax Type Registration
- Tax Agent Registration
- PIN Requests

Taxpayer Profile Management

- Update personal details

- Update company information
- Update addresses
- Update contact information
- Update bank details

Tax Administration

- Register additional tax types
- Update tax registrations
- File tax returns
- View registration information

Authorization Services

- Authorize company staff
- Authorize tax agents
- Manage Staff IDs (SSID)

Other Services

- View acknowledgements
- Submit online requests
- Access taxpayer information
- Manage security settings

7.9 Security Features

To protect taxpayer information, the IRD e-Services Portal includes several security measures.

These include:

- PIN authentication.
- Verification code (CAPTCHA).
- Account lockout after multiple incorrect login attempts.
- Mandatory PIN change after the first login.
- Password management for Staff IDs.
- Role-based access control for companies and tax agents.

7.10 Common Login Issues

Issue	Possible Cause	Suggested Solution
Incorrect PIN	Wrong PIN entered	Verify the PIN or request a new PIN if forgotten.
Account Locked	Five consecutive failed login attempts	Follow the IRD procedure to obtain a new PIN or seek assistance from the IRD.
Invalid TIN	Incorrect TIN entered	Check the TIN carefully before logging in.
Browser Issues	Unsupported browser or cached data	Clear the browser cache, close all browser windows, and try again using a supported browser.
Multiple Browser Tabs	More than one e-Services session open	

7.11 Best Practices for Using e-Services

Taxpayers should:

- Keep their PIN confidential.
- Log out after completing transactions.

- Keep their email address and mobile number up to date.
 - Change the PIN periodically.
 - Use only supported web browsers.
 - Avoid sharing login credentials with unauthorized persons.
 - Verify all submitted information before final submission.
-

7.12 Key Points

- The IRD e-Services Portal enables taxpayers to manage tax matters online.
- A valid **TIN** and **PIN** are required for access.
- Different login options are available for individuals, companies, authorized staff, and tax agents.
- Companies can authorize employees using **Staff Identification Numbers (SSID)**.
- Tax agents can only access taxpayer information after receiving formal authorization.
- The portal provides registration, profile management, tax filing, authorization, and other electronic tax services.
- Security features such as PIN authentication, CAPTCHA verification, and account lockout help protect taxpayer information.

Chapter 8 – Updating Taxpayer Information

8.1 Introduction

After obtaining a **Taxpayer Identification Number (TIN)**, taxpayers are responsible for ensuring that their registration information remains accurate and up to date. The Inland Revenue Department (IRD) requires taxpayers to update their personal, business, and contact information whenever changes occur. Keeping taxpayer information current helps ensure effective communication, accurate tax administration, and uninterrupted access to IRD e-Services.

Taxpayer information can be updated through the **IRD e-Services Portal** or by visiting the **Customer Information Update Unit** at the IRD Head Office or any Regional Office.

8.2 Why It Is Important to Update Taxpayer Information

Maintaining accurate taxpayer information helps the Inland Revenue Department to:

- Maintain correct taxpayer records.
- Deliver important notices and communications.
- Process tax registrations and returns efficiently.
- Verify taxpayer identity.
- Ensure uninterrupted access to e-Services.
- Avoid delays caused by outdated information.

Taxpayers are strongly advised to keep their **email address** and **mobile phone number** updated, as these are frequently used for communication and account-related notifications.

8.3 Methods of Updating Taxpayer Information

The IRD provides two methods for updating taxpayer information.

Method 1 – Online

Taxpayers can update their information using the IRD e-Services Portal.

General steps include:

1. Log in to the IRD e-Services Portal.

2. Navigate to **Taxpayer Registration**.
3. Select **Change Taxpayer Detail Request**.
4. Update the required information.
5. Upload supporting documents.
6. Review the application.
7. Submit the request.
8. Save the acknowledgement generated by the system.

Method 2 – In-Person

Taxpayers may also visit:

- Customer Information Update Unit
- IRD Head Office
- Any Regional Inland Revenue Office

Applicants should carry the required supporting documents for verification.

8.4 Updating Personal Information

Individual taxpayers may update various personal details, including:

- Name (where applicable)
- Permanent address
- Residential address
- Contact information
- Email address
- Mobile number
- Civil status
- Children's information
- Bank account information
- Individual business information

Changes should be supported by appropriate documentation where required.

8.5 Updating Address Information

Taxpayers may update:

- Permanent address
- Residential address
- Business address
- Tax type address (where applicable)

When updating an address, supporting documents may include:

- Utility bill
- Bank statement
- Grama Niladhari Certificate
- Lease agreement or deed (where applicable)

The new address should accurately reflect the taxpayer's current place of residence or business.

8.6 Updating Contact Information

Taxpayers should promptly update their:

- Mobile phone number
- Email address
- Other contact details

Maintaining current contact information helps ensure that important notifications, acknowledgements, and other communications from the IRD are delivered successfully.

8.7 Updating Business Information

Individual business owners may update information relating to their businesses.

Business details that can be updated include:

- Business name
- Business registration number
- Principal business activity
- Date of commencement
- Business address
- BOI registration details
- Primary business status

Where applicable, updated business registration certificates should be provided.

8.8 Updating Company Information

Registered companies may update information relating to:

- Company address
- Contact person
- Company contact details
- Directors
- Company registration information
- Bank account information

Depending on the nature of the change, supporting documents such as Registrar of Companies forms or amended registration certificates may be required.

8.9 Updating Director Information

Companies may add, remove, or update directors through the IRD e-Services Portal.

The system allows searches using:

- National Identity Card (NIC)
- Passport Number
- Taxpayer Identification Number (TIN)

If a director is already registered with the IRD, their information may be retrieved automatically.

Supporting documentation should be provided where necessary.

8.10 Supporting Documents Required

Depending on the information being updated, taxpayers may need to provide supporting documents.

Examples include:

Individuals

- National Identity Card (NIC)
- Passport (Foreign Nationals)
- Proof of Address
- Business Registration Certificate

Companies

- Amended Business Registration Certificate
- Registrar of Companies Forms
- Directors' Identification Documents
- Address Verification Documents

Partnerships

- Partnership Registration Certificate
- Identification of Partners
- Lease Agreement (where applicable)

Other Organizations

- Registration Certificate
- Letter of Request
- Letter of Appointment
- Trust Deed
- Joint Venture Agreement
- Gazette or Act (where applicable)

8.11 Uploading Supporting Documents

When submitting an online update request:

1. Select the appropriate document type.
2. Choose the relevant sub-document category.
3. Upload clear electronic copies.
4. Confirm successful upload.
5. Repeat the process for additional documents if required.

Poor-quality or incomplete documents may delay processing.

8.12 Declaration and Submission

Before submitting an update request, taxpayers should:

- Review all updated information.
- Ensure the details are accurate.
- Enter the required declaration information.
- Submit the request electronically.

Following successful submission, the system generates an acknowledgement, which should be retained for future reference.

8.13 Common Reasons for Update Requests

Taxpayers commonly update their information when:

- Moving to a new address.
- Changing their mobile number.
- Updating their email address.
- Starting a new business.
- Changing business activities.
- Appointing new company directors.
- Updating company registration details.
- Correcting previously submitted information.
- Updating bank account information.

8.14 Best Practices

Taxpayers should:

- Update changes as soon as possible.
- Ensure all supporting documents are current and accurate.
- Keep email addresses and mobile numbers active.
- Verify uploaded documents before submission.
- Retain acknowledgement receipts for future reference.
- Regularly review taxpayer information through the IRD e-Services Portal to ensure it

remains accurate.

8.15 Key Points

- Taxpayer information should be updated whenever personal, business, or contact details change.
- Updates can be completed online through the IRD e-Services Portal or by visiting an IRD office.
- Different supporting documents are required depending on the type of information being updated.
- Accurate taxpayer information helps prevent communication issues and delays in tax administration.
- Every successful update request generates an acknowledgement that should be retained for future reference.

Chapter 9 – Tax Type Registration

9.1 Introduction

Obtaining a **Taxpayer Identification Number (TIN)** is the first step in becoming a registered taxpayer. However, possessing a TIN alone does not automatically register a taxpayer for every tax administered by the Inland Revenue Department (IRD).

After obtaining a TIN, taxpayers must register for the specific **tax types** that apply to their income, business activities, or legal obligations. Tax type registration can be completed through the **IRD e-Services Portal** or by visiting the **Tax Registration Unit** at the IRD Head Office or any Regional Office.

9.2 What is Tax Type Registration?

Tax Type Registration is the process of registering an existing taxpayer for one or more taxes administered by the Inland Revenue Department.

A taxpayer registers only for the tax types applicable to their circumstances. Registration enables the taxpayer to meet legal obligations such as filing returns, making tax payments, and complying with tax laws.

9.3 Who Should Register for Tax Types?

Taxpayers should register for tax types based on their legal obligations.

Examples include:

Tax Type	Who Should Register
Income Tax	Persons liable to submit income tax returns.
Value Added Tax (VAT)	Businesses whose taxable supplies exceed the

	registration threshold or those registering voluntarily.
Withholding Tax (WHT)	Persons or entities required to deduct or account for withholding tax.
Other Tax Types	Taxpayers who become liable under the relevant tax laws.

9.4 Available Methods of Registration

Tax type registration can be completed in two ways.

Online Registration

Using the IRD e-Services Portal.

Manual Registration

By visiting:

- Tax Registration Unit
- IRD Head Office
- Any Regional Inland Revenue Office

Applicants who submit manual applications should complete the prescribed application forms and provide the required supporting documents.

9.5 Registering Through the IRD e-Services Portal

The online registration process generally includes:

1. Log in to the IRD e-Services Portal.
2. Select **Taxpayer Registration**.
3. Choose **Tax Type Request**.
4. View currently registered tax types.
5. Select the new tax type.

6. Enter the required information.
 7. Upload supporting documents (if required).
 8. Review the application.
 9. Submit the request.
 10. Save the acknowledgement for future reference.
-

9.6 Information Required During Registration

Depending on the selected tax type, taxpayers may need to provide additional information.

Examples include:

Income Tax

- Business address (where applicable)
- Relevant taxpayer information

VAT

- Business activities
- Business address
- VAT registration category
- Turnover information
- Supporting documents

Withholding Tax (WHT)

- Applicable withholding category

Additional information may be requested depending on the selected tax type.

9.7 Supporting Documents

The supporting documents required depend on the tax type being registered.

For most tax types, registration may not require additional supporting documents beyond the application.

However, **VAT registration** generally requires documentary evidence supporting taxable

business activities. Examples include:

- Sales invoices
- Purchase orders
- Sales agreements
- Bank statements
- Rent agreements
- Airway bills
- Bills of lading
- Commercial invoices
- Registration certificates issued by relevant authorities (where applicable)

Applicants registering voluntarily for VAT should indicate the purpose of registration.

9.8 Corporate Income Tax (CIT)

Companies registered with the Inland Revenue Department are **automatically registered for Corporate Income Tax (CIT)** after obtaining a TIN.

Therefore, companies are **not required to submit a separate application** for Corporate Income Tax registration.

9.9 Temporary VAT Registration

Temporary VAT registration is available for taxpayers involved in:

- Imports
- Exports
- Re-export activities

This registration is intended for persons who have not obtained permanent VAT registration but require VAT registration for customs-related activities.

Supporting documents may include:

- Bill of Lading
- Airway Bill
- Purchase Orders
- Purchase Agreements

Applications may be submitted online or through the Tax Registration Unit.

9.10 Simplified VAT Scheme (SVAT)

The Simplified Value Added Tax (SVAT) Scheme is available for certain taxpayers who are already registered for VAT.

Categories include:

- Registered Identified Suppliers (RIS)
- Registered Identified Purchasers (RIP)
- Specified Projects
- Strategic Development Projects
- Zero-rated suppliers
- Deemed exporters

SVAT registration requires additional documentation and is processed separately by the Inland Revenue Department.

9.11 Declaration and Submission

Before submitting a tax type registration request, taxpayers should:

- Review all entered information.
- Verify the accuracy of supporting documents.
- Complete the declaration.
- Provide the required contact information (where applicable).
- Submit the application.

After submission, the system generates an acknowledgement, which should be retained for future reference.

9.12 Processing of Applications

After submission:

1. The Inland Revenue Department reviews the application.
2. Supporting documents are verified.
3. Additional information may be requested if necessary.
4. Once approved, the requested tax type is activated in the taxpayer's profile.

Taxpayers should ensure that their registration details, including email address and mobile number, are up to date before applying for tax type registration.

9.13 Common Reasons for Registration Delays

Applications may be delayed due to:

- Incomplete application forms.
- Missing supporting documents.
- Incorrect taxpayer information.
- Unclear uploaded documents.
- Outdated contact information.
- Failure to provide mandatory declarations.

Providing complete and accurate information helps reduce processing delays.

9.14 Best Practices

Taxpayers should:

- Register only for tax types applicable to their activities.
 - Keep taxpayer registration information current before applying.
 - Upload clear supporting documents where required.
 - Save the acknowledgement after submission.
 - Retain copies of all supporting documents and correspondence.
-

9.15 Key Points

- **A TIN alone does not register a taxpayer for every tax type.**
- Taxpayers must register separately for the taxes that apply to them.
- Registration can be completed online through the IRD e-Services Portal or in person at an

IRD office.

- Companies are automatically registered for **Corporate Income Tax (CIT)** after obtaining a TIN.
- VAT registration generally requires additional supporting documents.
- Successful applications result in the activation of the relevant tax type in the taxpayer's IRD profile.

Chapter 10 – Staff Authorization, Staff Identification Numbers (SSID), and Tax Agents

10.1 Introduction

The Inland Revenue Department (IRD) allows taxpayers to authorize other persons to carry out tax-related activities on their behalf through the IRD e-Services Portal. This feature is particularly useful for companies, partnerships, and businesses that require employees or professional tax agents to prepare tax documents and manage tax matters.

To ensure security and accountability, the IRD provides an authorization system that uses **Staff Identification Numbers (SSID)** and **Tax Agent Authorizations**. Different levels of access can be assigned depending on the responsibilities of the authorized individual.

10.2 What is Staff Authorization?

Staff Authorization is the process by which a company or organization grants permission to an employee to perform tax-related activities on its behalf using the IRD e-Services Portal.

Only authorized staff members can access company tax records and perform the activities assigned to them.

Authorization is completed electronically through the IRD e-Services Portal.

10.3 What is a Staff Identification Number (SSID)?

A **Staff Identification Number (SSID)** is a unique identification number issued by the Inland Revenue Department to employees who are authorized to access the IRD e-Services Portal on behalf of a company or registered tax agent.

The SSID allows employees to log in securely and perform tax-related tasks without using the company's own login credentials.

Companies and registered tax agents can request SSIDs through the IRD e-Services Portal.

10.4 Who Can Request an SSID?

According to the IRD guidelines, SSIDs may be requested by:

- Registered Companies
- Registered Partnerships
- Registered Tax Agents

Individuals who manage only their own tax matters do not require an SSID.

10.5 Requesting Staff IDs (SSID)

Companies and registered tax agents can request Staff Identification Numbers through the IRD e-Services Portal.

The general process is:

1. Log in to the IRD e-Services Portal.
2. Navigate to **Authorisation**.
3. Select **Request SSID**.
4. Enter the number of Staff IDs required.
5. Submit the request.
6. Receive an acknowledgement confirming the request.

The IRD sends the approved SSIDs and their initial passwords to the registered postal address. Companies may request **up to 20 SSIDs** through the portal.

10.6 Activating Staff IDs

After receiving the SSID, it must be activated before use.

The activation process includes:

1. Log in to the IRD e-Services Portal.
2. Select **Authorisation → Change Staff Password**.
3. Enter the SSID.
4. Enter the employee's National Identity Card (NIC) number.
5. Issue the password.
6. Record the generated password.

During the employee's first login, the system requires the password to be changed for security purposes.

10.7 Authorizing Company Staff

After activating an SSID, the company must authorize the employee to perform tax-related activities.

The authorization process generally includes:

1. Log in to the IRD e-Services Portal.
2. Select **Authorisation → Create Staff Authorization**.
3. Enter the employee's TIN or SSID.
4. Search for the employee.
5. Select the applicable tax types.
6. Specify the authorization period.
7. Assign the employee's role.
8. Save the authorization request.

The system generates an acknowledgement confirming the authorization.

10.8 Staff Roles

The IRD provides two authorization roles for company staff.

Preparer

A **Preparer** may:

- Prepare tax returns.
- Save tax returns as drafts.
- Edit draft submissions.

A Preparer **cannot submit** tax returns to the IRD.

Approver

An **Approver** has all the permissions of a Preparer and may also:

- Review prepared returns.
- Submit returns to the Inland Revenue Department.

Organizations should assign these roles carefully to ensure appropriate internal controls.

10.9 Authorizing Tax Agents

Instead of authorizing internal staff, taxpayers may authorize a registered tax agent to manage their tax matters.

The authorization process includes:

1. Log in to the IRD e-Services Portal.
2. Select **Authorisation → Create Tax Agent Authorization**.
3. Enter the Tax Agent's TIN.
4. Search for the registered tax agent.
5. Select the relevant tax types.
6. Specify the effective period.
7. Save the authorization.

Unlike company staff, **tax agents are assigned only the Preparer role**. They may prepare tax submissions but cannot submit them on behalf of the taxpayer.

10.10 Registering as a Tax Agent

Individuals or partnerships wishing to act as tax agents must first register with the Inland Revenue Department.

Applicants must:

- Already possess a valid TIN.
- Meet one of the qualifications recognized by the IRD.
- Submit the required supporting documents.

Recognized qualifications include:

- Attorney-at-Law
 - Member of the Institute of Chartered Accountants of Sri Lanka
 - Member of the Sri Lanka Institute of Taxation
 - Registered Auditor approved under the applicable regulations
 - Any other category approved by the Commissioner General of Inland Revenue (CGIR).
-

10.11 Supporting Documents for Tax Agent Registration

Applicants should provide:

- National Identity Card (NIC) or Passport.
- Documentary proof of professional qualifications.
- Supporting evidence demonstrating eligibility to act as a tax agent.

Additional documentation may be requested by the Inland Revenue Department during the registration process.

10.12 Viewing and Managing Authorizations

The IRD e-Services Portal allows organizations and tax agents to manage existing authorizations.

Users may:

- Search for authorized staff.
- View all active authorizations.
- Modify authorization details.
- Terminate authorizations when staff members leave or no longer require access.

Keeping authorization records up to date helps maintain account security.

10.13 Security Considerations

Organizations should:

- Authorize only trusted individuals.
- Assign the minimum level of access required.

- Remove authorizations when no longer needed.
- Protect SSID passwords from unauthorized access.
- Ensure staff change their initial passwords during first login.
- Review active authorizations periodically.

10.14 Common Issues

Issue	Possible Solution
Staff cannot log in	Verify that the SSID has been activated and authorized.
Staff not appearing in search	Confirm the correct TIN or SSID was entered.
Tax Agent cannot access taxpayer records	Ensure the taxpayer has completed the Tax Agent Authorization process.
Forgotten SSID password	The company or registered tax agent can issue a new password through the IRD e-Services Portal.
Authorization expired	Create a new authorization or extend the authorization period as required.

10.15 Key Points

- Companies and registered tax agents can authorize employees to perform tax-related activities.
- Authorized employees receive a **Staff Identification Number (SSID)**.
- Staff must be authorized before accessing company tax records.
- The **Preparer** role allows users to prepare returns but not submit them.
- The **Approver** role allows users to prepare and submit returns.
- Registered tax agents must satisfy IRD qualification requirements before providing tax

services.

- Organizations should regularly review and manage staff and tax agent authorizations to maintain security and compliance.

Chapter 11 – Updating Tax Registration

11.1 Introduction

After obtaining a **Taxpayer Identification Number (TIN)**, a taxpayer may need to update their **tax registration** due to changes in business activities, tax obligations, or registration status. The Inland Revenue Department (IRD) allows registered taxpayers to update their tax registration electronically through the **IRD e-Services Portal**.

Updating tax registration ensures that the taxpayer's records accurately reflect their current tax obligations and helps maintain compliance with Sri Lankan tax laws. Taxpayers should update their registration promptly whenever changes occur that affect the taxes for which they are registered.

11.2 What is Tax Registration Updating?

Tax registration updating is the process of modifying the tax types or tax-related information already registered under a taxpayer's TIN.

This process does **not** create a new TIN. Instead, it updates the taxpayer's existing registration to reflect changes such as:

- Changes in business status.
- Changes in taxable activities.
- Updates to VAT project information.
- Changes affecting Income Tax, Corporate Income Tax (CIT), Withholding Tax (WHT), or other registered tax types.

These updates can be submitted online through the IRD e-Services Portal.

11.3 When Should Tax Registration Be Updated?

A taxpayer should submit a tax registration update whenever there are changes affecting their registered tax information.

Examples include:

- Commencing or ceasing taxable business activities.

- Changes to business operations.
- Changes in VAT-related projects.
- Changes in tax registration status.
- Any other changes requiring updates to existing tax registrations.

Keeping tax registration current helps ensure that tax records remain accurate and up to date.

11.4 Accessing the Tax Registration Update Service

To update tax registration online:

1. Visit the Inland Revenue Department website.
2. Log in to the **IRD e-Services Portal**.
3. Navigate to:

Taxpayer Registration → Change Tax Type Detail Request

The system displays the list of tax types currently registered under the taxpayer's profile.

11.5 Viewing Registered Tax Types

Once the **Change Tax Type Detail Request** page is opened, taxpayers can view all tax types currently registered under their TIN.

Depending on the taxpayer's profile, examples may include:

- Corporate Income Tax (CIT)
- Withholding Tax (WHT)
- Value Added Tax (VAT)
- Other applicable tax types

The taxpayer should select the relevant tax type that requires updating.

11.6 Updating Corporate Income Tax (CIT)

To update **Corporate Income Tax (CIT)** registration:

1. Select **CIT** from the registered tax types.
2. Review the existing registration details.
3. Update the registration status where necessary.
4. Save the changes.

The updated information is included in the application submitted to the Inland Revenue Department for review.

11.7 Updating Withholding Tax (WHT)

Taxpayers registered for **Withholding Tax (WHT)** may update their registration when their withholding obligations change.

The process includes:

1. Selecting **WHT**.
2. Updating the relevant registration information.
3. Saving the updated details.

The IRD reviews the request before updating the taxpayer's registration records.

11.8 Updating Value Added Tax (VAT)

Taxpayers registered for **Value Added Tax (VAT)** may update information relating to VAT registration.

The system allows updates to:

- VAT registration information.
- Project details.
- Registration status.

Where applicable, taxpayers may also request extensions relating to existing VAT projects.

11.9 Updating VAT Projects

Where VAT registration is associated with projects, taxpayers may manage project information through the portal.

Available options include:

Extending Existing Projects

The taxpayer may:

1. Select the existing project.
2. Tick the **Request for Extension** option.
3. Save the request.

Adding New Projects

To register a new project:

1. Select **Add Project**.
2. Enter the project information.
3. Provide the project address.
4. Save the project details.

The newly added project becomes part of the tax registration update request.

11.10 Supporting Documents

Where required, taxpayers must upload documents supporting the requested changes.

The process includes:

1. Selecting the appropriate **Document Type**.
2. Selecting the relevant **Sub-Document Type**.
3. Uploading the supporting document.
4. Confirming that the uploaded document appears in the application.

If an incorrect document is uploaded, it may be removed and replaced before submission.

11.11 Reviewing the Application

Before submission, the system displays a summary of the application.

Taxpayers should carefully review:

- Updated tax registration information.
- Supporting documents.
- Registration status.
- Project information (where applicable).

Corrections should be made before proceeding to the declaration stage.

11.12 Declaration

Before submitting the request, the taxpayer must complete the declaration by providing:

- Name
- Designation
- Contact Number

By submitting the declaration, the taxpayer confirms that all information provided is true, accurate, and complete.

11.13 Submission and Acknowledgement

After successful submission:

- The Inland Revenue Department receives the application.
- An acknowledgement page is generated.
- The taxpayer may print the acknowledgement for future reference.

The acknowledgement confirms that the request has been successfully submitted for processing.

11.14 Common Reasons for Updating Tax Registration

Taxpayers commonly update their tax registration when:

- Business activities change.
- VAT projects are extended.
- New VAT projects commence.
- Registration status changes.
- Tax obligations change.
- Additional supporting documents need to be submitted.

Timely updates help maintain accurate tax records and reduce administrative issues.

11.15 Best Practices

To ensure efficient processing, taxpayers should:

- Review all information before submission.
- Upload clear and complete supporting documents.
- Select the correct tax type for updating.
- Keep contact information up to date.
- Retain the acknowledgement after submission.
- Respond promptly if the IRD requests additional information.

These practices help avoid delays and facilitate accurate processing of tax registration updates.

11.16 Key Points

- Updating tax registration allows taxpayers to modify information relating to their existing tax registrations.
- Updates are completed through the **Taxpayer Registration → Change Tax Type Detail Request** service in the IRD e-Services Portal.
- Taxpayers may update **Corporate Income Tax (CIT)**, **Withholding Tax (WHT)**, **VAT**, and related project information.
- Supporting documents should be uploaded where required.
- Every application must be reviewed, declared, and submitted through the portal.
- A successful submission generates an acknowledgement that should be retained for future reference.

Chapter 12 – PIN and Account Security Management

12.1 Introduction

The Inland Revenue Department (IRD) has implemented several security measures to protect taxpayer information and ensure that only authorized users can access the **IRD e-Services Portal**. These measures include the use of a **Personal Identification Number (PIN)**, **Staff Identification Number (SSID)** passwords, account lockout mechanisms, password management procedures, and secure login practices.

Taxpayers are responsible for safeguarding their PINs and passwords and following the security recommendations issued by the Inland Revenue Department. Failure to do so may result in unauthorized access or temporary suspension of access to e-Services.

12.2 Importance of PIN Security

The Personal Identification Number (PIN) serves as the primary authentication credential for accessing IRD e-Services.

Proper PIN management helps to:

- Protect taxpayer information.
- Prevent unauthorized access.
- Secure online tax transactions.
- Maintain the confidentiality of tax records.
- Ensure compliance with IRD security requirements.

Taxpayers should treat their PIN as confidential information and avoid sharing it with any unauthorized person.

12.3 System-Generated PIN

When a taxpayer requests a PIN, the Inland Revenue Department issues a **system-generated PIN**.

The PIN is sent to the taxpayer through an official **PIN Mailer**, which is delivered to the taxpayer's registered postal address. If the PIN is requested in person at an IRD office, the taxpayer receives the PIN Mailer in a sealed envelope.

12.4 First-Time Login Security

When logging in with a newly issued system-generated PIN for the first time, the IRD e-Services Portal requires the taxpayer to change the PIN before any other services can be accessed.

This mandatory PIN change is a security measure designed to ensure that only the taxpayer knows the active PIN.

The taxpayer cannot continue using the portal until a new PIN has been successfully created.

12.5 Creating a New PIN

When changing the system-generated PIN:

- The new PIN must satisfy the system's minimum security requirements.
- The newly created PIN replaces the system-generated PIN immediately.
- The new PIN becomes the only valid PIN for future logins.

After the PIN has been changed, taxpayers should store it securely and use only the new PIN for future access to IRD e-Services.

12.6 Multiple PIN Requests

Taxpayers should avoid submitting multiple PIN requests.

Each new PIN request results in:

- Generation of a completely new PIN.
- Issuance of a new PIN Mailer.
- Immediate invalidation of all previously issued PINs.

Only the latest PIN issued by the Inland Revenue Department remains valid. Taxpayers should therefore wait for the most recent PIN Mailer before attempting to log in.

12.7 Forgotten or Lost PIN

If a taxpayer forgets the current PIN, a replacement PIN must be obtained.

A new PIN may be requested by:

- Submitting a PIN request through the IRD e-Services Portal.
- Visiting the nearest Inland Revenue Department office.

Once a replacement PIN has been issued, all earlier PINs become invalid.

12.8 Staff ID (SSID) Password Security

Companies and registered tax agents that use **Staff Identification Numbers (SSID)** must also manage SSID passwords securely.

Important requirements include:

- The initial system-generated password must be changed during the first login.
 - Companies or tax agents are responsible for managing SSID passwords.
 - The Inland Revenue Department does not reset SSID passwords on behalf of companies.
 - Password changes can be completed through the IRD e-Services Portal.
-

12.9 Account Lockout

The IRD e-Services Portal includes an account lockout mechanism to prevent unauthorized access.

An account is automatically locked after **five consecutive incorrect login attempts** involving an incorrect TIN/PIN or SSID/password combination.

If the account becomes locked:

- The taxpayer should avoid making further login attempts using incorrect credentials.
- A new PIN may need to be requested if the current PIN cannot be remembered.
- SSID password issues should be resolved by the company or registered tax agent through the e-Services Portal.

12.10 Browser Security and Login Issues

The IRD recommends the following practices when using the e-Services Portal:

- Log out after completing all activities.
- Clear the browser cache if unexpected errors occur.
- Close all browser windows before logging in again.
- Use only **one browser tab** when accessing the IRD e-Services Portal, as multiple tabs may cause system errors.
- Use a supported web browser for the best experience.

12.11 Recommended Security Practices

To protect taxpayer accounts, the Inland Revenue Department recommends that taxpayers:

- Do not share their PIN with anyone.
- Keep the PIN confidential.
- Change the PIN periodically (approximately every six months).
- Store the PIN securely.
- Log out after completing online activities.
- Verify login credentials before attempting to sign in.
- Keep registered contact details up to date.

Following these practices helps reduce the risk of unauthorized access to taxpayer accounts.

12.12 Common Security Issues

Issue	Cause	Recommended Action
Forgotten PIN	PIN cannot be remembered	Request a new PIN through the IRD e-Services Portal or visit an IRD office.

Multiple PIN Requests	Several PIN requests submitted before receiving the previous PIN	Wait for the latest PIN Mailer and use only the newest PIN.
Account Locked	Five incorrect login attempts	Follow the IRD PIN recovery procedure or request a new PIN if necessary.
SSID Password Forgotten	Password lost by company staff	The company or registered tax agent should reset the password through the e-Services Portal.
Browser Error	Multiple browser tabs or cached information	Log out, clear the browser cache, close all browser windows, and try again using a single browser tab.

12.13 Frequently Asked Questions

Can I continue using my old PIN after requesting a new one?

No. Every new PIN request automatically invalidates all previously issued PINs. Only the latest PIN remains valid.

How often should I change my PIN?

The IRD recommends changing the PIN periodically, approximately once every six months, to

improve account security.

What happens if I enter the wrong PIN several times?

The account will be locked after five consecutive incorrect login attempts.

Can the IRD reset an SSID password?

No. SSID passwords must be managed by the company or registered tax agent through the IRD e-Services Portal.

12.14 Key Points

- The PIN is the primary security credential for accessing IRD e-Services.
- A system-generated PIN must be changed during the first login.
- Every new PIN request invalidates all previous PINs.
- Accounts are automatically locked after five incorrect login attempts.
- Companies are responsible for managing SSID passwords.
- Taxpayers should protect their PIN, change it periodically, and follow IRD security recommendations to maintain secure access to their tax records.

Chapter 13 – Troubleshooting and Common Issues

13.1 Introduction

During TIN registration and the use of IRD e-Services, taxpayers may experience various issues related to registration, login, PIN management, tax registration updates, or profile maintenance. The Inland Revenue Department (IRD) provides procedures to resolve these issues through the IRD e-Services Portal or by visiting an IRD office.

This chapter outlines the most common problems faced by taxpayers and the recommended actions based on the official IRD guidance.

13.2 TIN Registration Issues

Problem: Registration Application is Rejected

A TIN registration application may be rejected if:

- Required information is incomplete.
- Mandatory fields are left blank.
- Supporting documents are missing.
- Uploaded documents are unclear or unreadable.
- Information provided does not match official records.

Solution

- Review the application carefully.
 - Correct any incorrect information.
 - Upload clear supporting documents.
 - Resubmit the application if required.
-

Problem: Supporting Documents Cannot Be Uploaded

Possible causes include:

- Unsupported document format.
- Corrupted file.
- Poor-quality scanned document.
- Incorrect document category selected.

Solution

- Scan documents clearly.
 - Upload the correct document type.
 - Ensure files are complete and readable before submission.
-

13.3 PIN Issues

Problem: PIN Mailer Not Received

After requesting a PIN online, the PIN Mailer is sent to the taxpayer's registered postal address.

If it is not received within approximately **two weeks**, taxpayers should visit the nearest Inland Revenue Department office.

Problem: Forgot PIN

If the current PIN is forgotten:

- Submit a new PIN request through the IRD e-Services Portal, or
- Visit the nearest IRD office.

A new PIN will be issued, and all previous PINs will become invalid.

Problem: Old PIN Does Not Work

Every new PIN request automatically invalidates all previously issued PINs.

Solution

Use only the latest PIN issued by the Inland Revenue Department.

13.4 Login Issues

Problem: Cannot Log In

Possible reasons include:

- Incorrect TIN.
- Incorrect PIN.
- Incorrect CAPTCHA.
- Locked account.
- Browser issues.

Solution

- Verify the TIN.
 - Verify the PIN.
 - Enter the CAPTCHA correctly.
 - Clear the browser cache.
 - Close all browser windows.
 - Use only one browser tab.
 - Use a supported browser.
-

Problem: Account Locked

The IRD e-Services Portal automatically locks an account after **five consecutive incorrect login attempts**.

Solution

- Stop further login attempts.
 - Request a new PIN if necessary.
 - Visit an IRD office if assistance is required.
-

13.5 Updating Profile Issues

Problem: Personal Details Cannot Be Updated

Possible reasons include:

- Missing supporting documents.

- Incorrect document type selected.
- Incomplete declaration.

Solution

- Upload the required supporting documents.
 - Complete the declaration.
 - Review the summary before submitting the request.
-

Problem: Address Change Not Accepted

Possible causes include:

- No proof of address provided.
- Incorrect address details.
- Supporting document does not match the new address.

Solution

Submit valid proof of address such as:

- Utility bill
- Bank statement
- Grama Niladhari Certificate

Ensure the information matches the application.

13.6 Tax Registration Issues

Problem: Unable to Update Tax Registration

Possible reasons include:

- Incorrect tax type selected.
- Missing supporting documents.
- Incomplete project information (for VAT).

Solution

- Select the correct registered tax type.
 - Upload all required supporting documents.
 - Review the application before submission.
-

13.7 SSID Issues

Problem: Staff Cannot Access Company Tax Records

Possible reasons include:

- SSID has not been activated.
- Employee has not been authorized.
- Authorization period has expired.

Solution

- Activate the SSID.
 - Create a Staff Authorization.
 - Renew or recreate the authorization if necessary.
-

Problem: Forgotten SSID Password

SSID passwords are managed by the company or registered tax agent.

Solution

Reset the password through the IRD e-Services Portal. The IRD does not reset SSID passwords on behalf of companies.

13.8 Tax Agent Issues

Problem: Tax Agent Cannot Access Client Information

Possible reasons include:

- The taxpayer has not authorized the tax agent.

- Incorrect Tax Agent TIN entered.
- Authorization has expired.

Solution

- Complete the Tax Agent Authorization process.
 - Verify the Tax Agent's TIN.
 - Create a new authorization if necessary.
-

13.9 Browser and Technical Issues

Technical issues may occur due to browser settings.

Common solutions include:

- Clear browser cache.
 - Close all browser windows.
 - Open a new browser session.
 - Use only one browser tab.
 - Use a supported browser version.
-

13.10 When to Contact the Inland Revenue Department

Taxpayers should contact the IRD if:

- The TIN registration cannot be completed.
- The PIN Mailer is not received within the expected period.
- Registration details cannot be updated.
- Tax registration requests are repeatedly rejected.
- Technical problems cannot be resolved using the recommended troubleshooting steps.

The **Taxpayer Services Unit (TPSU)** and the IRD Call Centre are available to assist taxpayers with registration, PIN requests, taxpayer profile updates, and other tax-related services.

13.11 Frequently Asked Questions

I forgot my PIN. What should I do?

Request a new PIN through the IRD e-Services Portal or visit an IRD office. All previous PINs become invalid after a new PIN is issued.

My account is locked. Can I unlock it myself?

If your account is locked after five incorrect login attempts, follow the IRD procedure to obtain a new PIN or seek assistance from the IRD.

I uploaded the wrong document. Can I replace it?

Yes. Before submission, uploaded documents can be removed and replaced with the correct documents through the e-Services Portal.

Why can't my employee log in using the SSID?

Ensure the SSID has been activated, the password has been changed after first login, and the employee has been properly authorized by the company.

13.12 Key Points

- Most registration and login issues can be resolved by reviewing application details, updating documents, or following the IRD recovery procedures.
- PIN-related issues are among the most common and usually require requesting a new PIN if the existing one cannot be used.
- Companies must manage SSID passwords and staff authorizations through the IRD e-Services Portal.
- Browser-related issues can often be resolved by clearing the cache, using a supported browser, and avoiding multiple browser tabs.
- If issues cannot be resolved through the e-Services Portal, taxpayers should contact the Inland Revenue Department for further assistance.

Chapter 14 – Inland Revenue Department (IRD) Support Services

14.1 Introduction

The Inland Revenue Department (IRD) provides several support services to assist taxpayers with registration, tax compliance, e-Services, and general tax-related inquiries. These services are available to individuals, businesses, companies, tax agents, and other registered taxpayers.

Taxpayers may obtain assistance through the **Taxpayer Services Unit (TPSU)**, the **IRD Call Centre**, the **e-Services Portal**, or by visiting an Inland Revenue office. The purpose of these support services is to help taxpayers understand their obligations, complete registrations, access online services, and resolve administrative issues efficiently.

14.2 Taxpayer Services Unit (TPSU)

The **Taxpayer Services Unit (TPSU)** is the primary service center established by the Inland Revenue Department to provide assistance to taxpayers.

The TPSU offers guidance and support on various taxpayer services and assists both registered and unregistered taxpayers with tax-related matters.

14.3 Services Provided by the TPSU

According to the official IRD guidance, the Taxpayer Services Unit provides assistance with:

- Registration as a taxpayer.
 - Issuing of Taxpayer Identification Numbers (TIN).
 - Registration for tax types.
 - Updating taxpayer registration details.
 - Issuing Personal Identification Numbers (PIN) for e-Services.
 - Issuing Tax Clearance Certificates.
 - Providing advice on tax responsibilities and obligations.
 - Accepting tax returns and supporting documents.
 - General taxpayer assistance and guidance.
-

14.4 IRD Call Centre

The Inland Revenue Department operates a Call Centre to provide information and guidance on tax-related matters.

The Call Centre assists taxpayers by:

- Answering general tax inquiries.
- Providing information on taxpayer registration.
- Explaining tax procedures.
- Directing taxpayers to the appropriate IRD service.
- Providing guidance on e-Services.

Taxpayers should have their **Taxpayer Identification Number (TIN)** available when contacting the Call Centre regarding their tax records.

14.5 Online Help Services

The IRD e-Services Portal includes online help features designed to assist taxpayers while completing electronic applications.

These features include:

- Help icons displayed next to selected fields.
- Instructions explaining information required for each section.
- Electronic guidance during registration and profile updates.

Taxpayers are encouraged to review these instructions carefully before submitting applications.

14.6 Help Categories Available

The IRD support system provides assistance in several categories.

General Information

Information relating to:

- Taxpayer registration.
- Tax obligations.

- General administrative procedures.

Tax-Related Matters

Support relating to:

- Income Tax.
- Value Added Tax (VAT).
- Withholding Tax (WHT).
- Other taxes administered by the Inland Revenue Department.

Complaints

Taxpayers may also submit:

- Complaints.
- Reports relating to tax evasion.
- Other general concerns requiring investigation.

14.7 Support for Registered and Unregistered Taxpayers

The Inland Revenue Department provides assistance to both:

Registered Taxpayers

Support includes:

- Updating taxpayer information.
- Tax type registration.
- PIN requests.
- e-Service assistance.
- Filing-related inquiries.

Unregistered Taxpayers

Support includes:

- Information about taxpayer registration.
- Guidance on obtaining a TIN.
- Registration procedures.
- Required supporting documents.

14.8 Office Hours

According to the official IRD guidance:

Taxpayer Services Unit

- Monday to Friday
- **8:30 a.m. – 4:00 p.m.**
- Closed on public holidays

IRD Call Centre

- Monday to Friday
- **9:00 a.m. – 7:00 p.m.**

Saturday

- **9:00 a.m. – 1:00 p.m.**

These operating hours may change in accordance with official IRD announcements. Taxpayers should verify current office hours before visiting an IRD office.

14.9 Situations Where Taxpayers Should Seek Assistance

Taxpayers should consider contacting the Inland Revenue Department if they:

- Need to register for a TIN.
 - Need to obtain a PIN.
 - Experience login problems.
 - Need to update taxpayer details.
 - Need to update tax registration.
 - Require clarification regarding tax obligations.
 - Need assistance with e-Services.
 - Need guidance regarding tax returns.
 - Require a Tax Clearance Certificate.
 - Need help resolving registration issues.
-

14.10 Preparing Before Contacting the IRD

Before contacting the Inland Revenue Department, taxpayers should have the following information available where applicable:

- Taxpayer Identification Number (TIN).
- National Identity Card (NIC) or Passport.
- Registration acknowledgement number.
- Relevant supporting documents.
- Details of the issue requiring assistance.

Having this information readily available helps IRD officers identify taxpayer records and provide assistance more efficiently.

14.11 Best Practices When Seeking Assistance

To receive efficient support, taxpayers should:

- Keep their taxpayer information up to date.
 - Retain copies of acknowledgements and supporting documents.
 - Clearly describe the issue requiring assistance.
 - Follow instructions provided by IRD officers.
 - Use the IRD e-Services Portal whenever possible for routine services.
 - Contact the appropriate IRD service for the type of assistance required.
-

14.12 Frequently Asked Questions

Where can I obtain a TIN?

You may register online through the IRD e-Services Portal or visit the Taxpayer Services Unit (TPSU) or a Regional Inland Revenue Office.

Where can I obtain a PIN?

A PIN can be requested online through the IRD e-Services Portal or by visiting an IRD office.

Can the TPSU help me update my taxpayer information?

Yes. The TPSU provides assistance with updating taxpayer registration information and related services.

Can I receive assistance if I am not yet registered?

Yes. The TPSU provides guidance for both registered and unregistered taxpayers regarding TIN registration and related procedures.

14.13 Key Points

- The Inland Revenue Department provides several support services for taxpayers.
- The **Taxpayer Services Unit (TPSU)** assists with TIN registration, PIN requests, taxpayer profile updates, tax type registration, tax clearance certificates, and general taxpayer guidance.
- The **IRD Call Centre** provides telephone assistance during official operating hours.
- The **IRD e-Services Portal** includes online help features to assist taxpayers when completing electronic applications.
- Taxpayers should keep their TIN, identification documents, and acknowledgement numbers available when requesting assistance.
- Seeking assistance promptly helps resolve registration, login, and tax administration issues more efficiently.

Chapter 15 – Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)

15.1 Introduction

This chapter answers common questions regarding **TIN registration, PIN management, IRD e-Services, taxpayer information, and tax registration** based on the official Inland Revenue Department (IRD) guidance. It is intended to provide quick reference answers for taxpayers.

General Questions

1. What is a Taxpayer Identification Number (TIN)?

A TIN is a unique identification number issued by the Inland Revenue Department to identify a taxpayer for tax administration and access to IRD services.

2. Does having a TIN mean I have to pay income tax?

No. A TIN is an identification number. Income tax liability depends on your taxable income and applicable tax laws.

3. Who must register for a TIN?

Individuals aged 18 years and above, businesses, partnerships, companies, trusts, joint ventures, and other eligible entities should register as required by IRD regulations.

4. Can a student obtain a TIN?

Yes. Eligible individuals may register even if they are students or currently have no taxable income.

5. Can foreigners apply for a TIN?

Yes. Foreign nationals may register by providing a valid passport and any other required supporting documents.

Registration Questions

6. How can I apply for a TIN?

You can apply:

- Online through the IRD e-Services Portal.
 - At an IRD office.
 - By post.
-

7. What documents are required?

Requirements depend on the applicant type. Generally, identification documents, proof of address, and business registration documents (where applicable) are required.

8. Can someone submit the application on my behalf?

Yes. An authorized representative may submit the application if a valid letter of authority is provided.

9. How long does registration take?

Processing time varies depending on the application method and document verification. Complete applications are generally processed more quickly.

PIN Questions

10. Why do I need a PIN?

A PIN is required to log in to the IRD e-Services Portal and use online tax services.

11. How do I obtain a PIN?

You can request a PIN online through the IRD e-Services Portal or in person at an IRD office.

12. What happens if I forget my PIN?

Request a new PIN. Once a new PIN is issued, all previously issued PINs become invalid.

13. Why must I change the PIN during my first login?

The system requires the system-generated PIN to be replaced with a personal PIN for security reasons.

e-Services Questions

14. What information do I need to log in?

- TIN
 - PIN
 - Verification code (CAPTCHA)
-

15. What can I do through IRD e-Services?

You can:

- Register for tax types.
- Update taxpayer information.
- Submit requests.

- File tax returns.
 - Manage authorizations.
 - Access other online tax services.
-

16. Why is my account locked?

The account is locked after five consecutive incorrect login attempts.

Updating Information

17. Can I change my address online?

Yes. Address changes can be submitted through **Taxpayer Registration → Change Taxpayer Detail Request**. Supporting documents may be required.

18. Can I update my mobile number and email address?

Yes. Contact details can be updated through the IRD e-Services Portal.

19. Can I update my business information?

Yes. Registered businesses can update business details and submit supporting documents where required.

Tax Registration

20. Does obtaining a TIN automatically register me for every tax?

No. You must register separately for the applicable tax types.

21. Can I update my tax registration later?

Yes. Existing tax registrations can be updated through the **Change Tax Type Detail Request** service.

Staff and Tax Agents

22. What is an SSID?

An SSID is a Staff Identification Number issued to authorized employees who access IRD e-Services on behalf of a company or registered tax agent.

23. Can a tax agent submit returns on behalf of a taxpayer?

A tax agent must first be authorized by the taxpayer. The permissions available depend on the assigned authorization role.

Support

24. Where can I get help?

Support is available through:

- Taxpayer Services Unit (TPSU)
 - IRD Call Centre
 - IRD e-Services Portal
 - Regional Inland Revenue Offices
-

Key Points

- A TIN identifies a taxpayer; it does not by itself create an income tax liability.
- A PIN is required to access IRD e-Services.
- Taxpayer information and tax registrations can be updated online.

- Companies can authorize employees through SSIDs.
- Assistance is available through the IRD's support services and regional offices.

Chapter 16 – Glossary of Terms

16.1 Introduction

This glossary explains common terms used by the **Inland Revenue Department (IRD)** in relation to taxpayer registration, e-Services, and tax administration. The definitions are based on the official IRD guides and are intended to help users understand terminology used throughout this knowledge base.

A

Acknowledgement

A confirmation generated by the IRD after an online application or request has been successfully submitted. It serves as proof that the request has been received for processing.

Authorized Representative

A person who is permitted to act on behalf of a taxpayer. A valid letter of authority may be required depending on the service requested.

B

BOI

Board of Investment of Sri Lanka. Certain businesses registered with the BOI may be required to provide BOI-related information during taxpayer registration.

C

Corporate Taxpayer

A registered company or organization that manages its tax obligations through the IRD e-

Services Portal.

CAPTCHA

A security verification displayed during login to confirm that the user is a real person before access is granted to the IRD e-Services Portal.

D

Declaration

The final confirmation completed before submitting an online application, where the applicant confirms that the information provided is true and complete.

E

e-Services Portal

The Inland Revenue Department's online platform that allows taxpayers to register, update information, manage tax registrations, and access other electronic tax services.

I

Inland Revenue Department (IRD)

The government authority responsible for administering taxes in Sri Lanka, including taxpayer registration, tax collection, and operation of the e-Services Portal.

N

National Identity Card (NIC)

The primary identification document used by Sri Lankan citizens during taxpayer registration and other IRD services.

P

Personal Identification Number (PIN)

A confidential security code issued by the IRD that allows registered taxpayers to log in to the IRD e-Services Portal.

Partnership

A business owned by two or more persons that may register with the IRD and obtain a TIN.

R

Registered Company

A company incorporated under the applicable laws of Sri Lanka and registered with the Registrar of Companies. Such companies may apply for a TIN and access IRD e-Services.

ROC

Registrar of Companies. The government authority responsible for company registration. Companies may be required to submit ROC-issued documents during TIN registration.

S

Sole Proprietorship

A business owned and operated by one individual. The owner registers as an individual taxpayer and may include business details during TIN registration.

Staff Identification Number (SSID)

A unique number issued by the IRD to authorized employees of companies or registered tax agents, allowing them to access the IRD e-Services Portal on behalf of their organization.

Supporting Documents

Documents submitted with an application to verify the applicant’s identity, address, business registration, or other required information.

T

Tax Agent

A person or organization registered with the IRD and authorized by a taxpayer to perform specified tax-related activities on the taxpayer’s behalf.

Tax Registration

The process of registering a taxpayer for one or more tax types administered by the IRD.

Tax Type

A category of tax administered by the IRD, such as Income Tax, Value Added Tax (VAT), or Withholding Tax (WHT). Taxpayers register only for the tax types that apply to them.

Taxpayer

An individual or organization that is registered with the IRD and identified by a Taxpayer Identification Number (TIN).

Taxpayer Identification Number (TIN)

A unique identification number issued by the Inland Revenue Department to identify taxpayers and administer tax-related services.

Taxpayer Services Unit (TPSU)

The IRD unit responsible for assisting taxpayers with registration, PIN requests, taxpayer profile updates, tax type registration, and other taxpayer services.

V

Value Added Tax (VAT)

A tax type administered by the IRD that applies to eligible businesses involved in the supply of taxable goods and services, subject to the applicable provisions of tax law.

W

Withholding Tax (WHT)

A tax type under which tax is withheld at the source in accordance with the applicable provisions of Sri Lankan tax law.

Key Points

- Understanding IRD terminology helps taxpayers complete registrations and use e-Services correctly.
- The glossary serves as a quick reference for commonly used terms throughout this knowledge base.
- Definitions are based on the official IRD guidance and should be read together with the relevant chapters for detailed procedures.

Chapter 17 – Best Practices and Compliance Guidelines

17.1 Introduction

Maintaining accurate taxpayer information and following the Inland Revenue Department (IRD) procedures helps taxpayers comply with tax administration requirements and avoid unnecessary delays. This chapter summarizes recommended practices for TIN registration, use of IRD e-Services, account security, and taxpayer record management based on the official IRD guidance.

17.2 Before Registering for a TIN

Before submitting a TIN application, applicants should:

- Confirm that they are eligible for registration.
 - Select the correct taxpayer category.
 - Prepare all required supporting documents.
 - Ensure identification documents are valid and up to date.
 - Provide accurate contact information, including a current email address and mobile number.
 - Verify that all information entered matches the supporting documents.
-

17.3 During Registration

To reduce processing delays:

- Complete all mandatory fields.
 - Upload clear and legible supporting documents.
 - Select the correct document type for each upload.
 - Review the application before submission.
 - Complete the declaration accurately.
 - Save the acknowledgement after submitting the application.
-

17.4 Managing Your TIN

After receiving a TIN, taxpayers should:

- Keep the TIN in a secure place.

- Use the same TIN for all future dealings with the IRD.
 - Avoid applying for a duplicate TIN.
 - Quote the TIN in correspondence with the Inland Revenue Department where required.
-

17.5 Protecting Your PIN and Account

Taxpayers should follow these security practices:

- Keep the PIN confidential.
 - Change the system-generated PIN during the first login.
 - Do not share the PIN with unauthorized persons.
 - Change the PIN periodically.
 - Avoid repeated incorrect login attempts.
 - Log out after using the IRD e-Services Portal.
-

17.6 Keeping Taxpayer Information Current

Taxpayers should promptly update changes to:

- Residential or business address.
- Mobile number.
- Email address.
- Business information.
- Company details.
- Directors (for companies).
- Bank account information where applicable.

Keeping records current helps ensure that communications from the IRD are received without delay.

17.7 Managing Tax Registrations

When business activities or tax obligations change, taxpayers should:

- Register for new tax types when required.
- Update existing tax registrations.
- Submit supporting documents where applicable.

- Review tax registration details periodically for accuracy.
-

17.8 Managing Staff and Tax Agent Access

Companies and organizations should:

- Authorize only trusted employees.
 - Assign appropriate user roles.
 - Remove authorizations when employees leave the organization.
 - Keep SSID passwords secure.
 - Review active staff and tax agent authorizations regularly.
-

17.9 Record Keeping

Taxpayers are encouraged to retain copies of:

- TIN registration acknowledgements.
- PIN request acknowledgements.
- Tax registration update acknowledgements.
- Supporting documents submitted to the IRD.
- Correspondence received from the IRD.

Maintaining these records can assist with future updates, inquiries, and verification processes.

17.10 Using IRD e-Services Effectively

For a smoother experience when using the IRD e-Services Portal:

- Use a supported web browser.
- Use a stable internet connection.
- Avoid opening multiple browser tabs for the same session.
- Verify information before submitting online requests.
- Save acknowledgement receipts after each successful submission.

17.11 Key Points

- Submit complete and accurate information during registration.

- Protect your TIN, PIN, and login credentials.
- Update taxpayer and tax registration details whenever changes occur.
- Keep supporting documents and acknowledgement receipts for future reference.
- Review your taxpayer information regularly to ensure it remains accurate.
- Follow official IRD procedures when using e-Services or requesting assistance.